

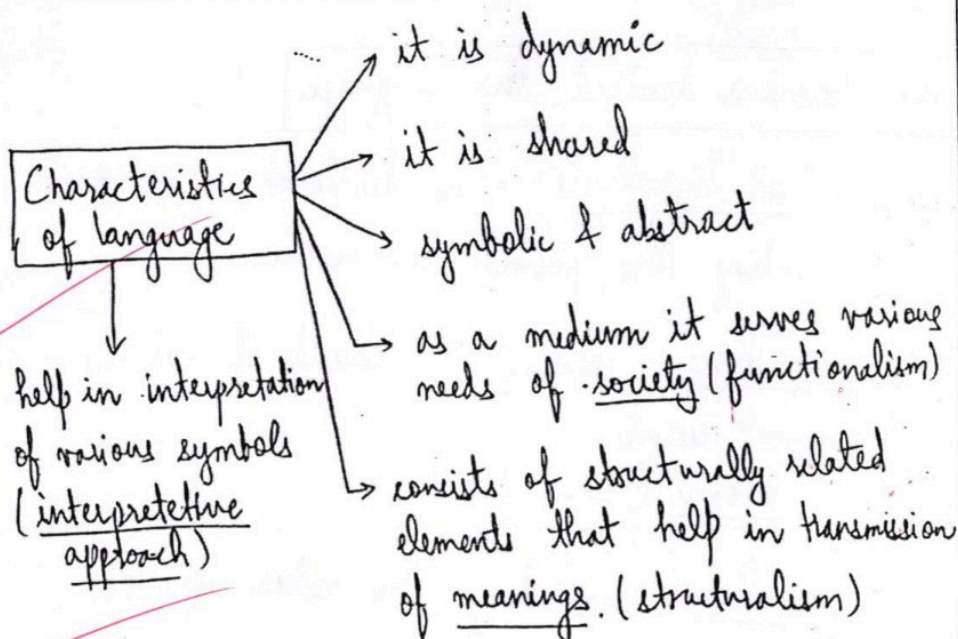
E2A™

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(c) Write a note on the origin and characteristics of Language

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As per Bernard Bloch & GL Trager, language is a system of vocal or written symbols through which ~ social groups communicate.



Origin of Language

1) Divine Theory: language was gifted to mankind through divine creation. However, this theory has no scientific basis

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- 2) Evolution Theory: It argued that during course of evolution, language developed as device to communicate when mankind gathered the ability to speak.

How humans devised the language

- 1) Imitation hypothesis: man developed language by imitating the sound in nature.

- a) Ding dong: copying the sound of various natural events.

eg: Boom (bomb blast)

- b) Poo - Poo: imitating the ~~natur~~ response of expressions.

eg: Ha Ha Ha (laughter)

- c) Bow - Wow: copying the noise of animals

eg: Moo (cow)

1) Ta-Ta: by Charles Darwin, response through help of hand gestures
eg: Bye or Ta-Ta

2) Necessity hypothesis: language developed as the arising necessity.

a) Warning: language developed to issue warning of any predator attack during early times.

b) Yoo-he-yo: to ensure collective effort during a task.

eg: Ho-Ha during construction activity.

c) Lying: man devised language in order to lie.

~~Despite these~~

Criticism

not able to explain the
need of symbols

ignored various social
processes.

Royal Linguistic society in 20th century rejected all the hypotheses. At present, there is no one theory that can explain origin of language.